

region is also anticipated to manifest the fastest CAGR of 12.3 per cent from 2020 to 2027.

Government to develop 500 champion MSMEs in electronics

The government of India is taking steps to create 500 champion MSMEs in the electronics sector. This information was revealed by Saurabh Gaur, IAS, joint secretary, Ministry of Electronics & Information Technology, Government of India, during a webinar of MVIRDC Research Study on Promoting Electronic Manufacturing.

“Government of India is taking efforts to develop 500 champion MSMEs in the electronics sector. Global and Indian electronics companies have committed USD 100 billion production, eighty per cent of which is for exports under the production linked incentive scheme so far. This revenue positive scheme will create 250,000 direct and indirect employment and also generate significant tax revenue for government,” says Gaur.

“In case of set-top boxes, India domestically develops conditional access systems (CAS), although we are dependent on imports to a large extent. India will also make progress in domestic manufacturing of Internet of Things (IoT) and wearable devices,” Gaur adds.

The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) had recently asked various ministries to formulate plans for boosting domestic manufacturing of goods in the 24 key areas identified by it. Electronics was identified as a key sector among the key 24 sectors.

PSUs to set up polysilicon manufacturing plants to cut solar dependence on China

As per a report by the Financial Express, a senior official from the ministry of new and renewable energy (MNRE) said that the Chinese manufacturers have increased the price of wafers, which is used in the manufacturing of cells, after India increased the production of cells under the Atmanirbhar Bharat initiative.

The report adds that public sector companies like NTPC and BHEL may

set up polysilicon manufacturing plants in the country to help reduce India's dependence on China for the import of wafers, ingots, and cells for integrated manufacturing of solar modules under the Atmanirbhar Bharat Abhiyan.

As per the report, the official says that to overcome the issue of high-handedness of Chinese manufacturers, the Indian government is in talks with PSUs to set up around 10GW of polysilicon manufacturing capacity in India. Polysilicon is used to make ingots and wafers. It is readily available for imports from countries outside of China like South Korea.

As per industry standards, one gigawatt of polysilicon capacity costs anywhere between 12.5 and 15 billion rupees. The report says that MNRE is also working on a scheme to provide financial incentives to the manufacturers willing to set up polysilicon, ingots, and wafers plants.

UL accredited as a certification body for household appliances in India

UL has been accredited as a certification body for testing and certification of certain household appliances in India. The accreditation was done by the National Accreditation Board for Certification Bodies (NABCB).

“The NABCB accreditation is recognition of the technical competence and testing capabilities of UL's laboratories in India, together with the strength in our processes and systems. We take great pride in being accredited for the evaluation of energy efficiency norms of household appliances that are witnessing huge demand and consumption due to the new normal. With this accreditation, we can enable original equipment manufacturers to minimise risk and costs due to retesting as the NABCB accreditation allows acceptance of compliance certificates in multiple markets,” says Suresh Sugavanam, vice president and managing director of UL in South Asia and Sub-Saharan Africa.

With the NABCB accreditation, the UL laboratory in Gurugram can issue a certificate of compliance to manufacturers of direct cool and frost-free refrigerators, microwave ovens,

storage water heaters, and LED lamps provided they meet requirements as per Bureau of Energy Efficiency Standards.

Aequs to invest 35 billion rupees in consumer electronics cluster in Karnataka

As per a report by Livemint, the Karnataka government has approved 35.4 billion rupees investment by Aequs SEZ Private Limited to develop a consumer electronics and durables goods (CEDG) cluster in Hubballi.

The report says that Aequs is India's first sector-specific investment in line with Atmanirbhar initiative. The report adds that this investment is expected to generate around 20,000 jobs.

The company has requested the Karnataka Industrial Area Development Board (KIADB) for allotment and acquisition of 400-acre land in Ittigatti village in Dharwad as per a senior government official. The proposed industrial unit will comprise warehouse facilities, logistics hub, skill development centre, and other support services, as per the proposal.

Tesla plans to enter India next year

Tesla's chief executive officer Elon Musk said that Tesla will enter the Indian market in 2021. “Next year for sure,” Musk said while replying to a query on Tesla's India plans on Twitter.

Last year, Musk had tweeted that high duties on vehicles imported as completely built units (CBUs) in India prevented Tesla from entering the Indian market. Low per capita income and lack of infrastructure for EVs were other factors.

There are also reports that Tesla has held discussions with the Karnataka government for possible investments for a research facility in Bengaluru. It is expected that there will be another meeting soon in which the government officials are likely to present a proposal to Tesla.

Reports have also said that Tesla has shown initial interest to invest in a research and innovation centre in Karnataka. These talks are at initial states.